SkillNavora Academy

Market Research

The Complete Digital Marketing Course · Chapter 2 of 19

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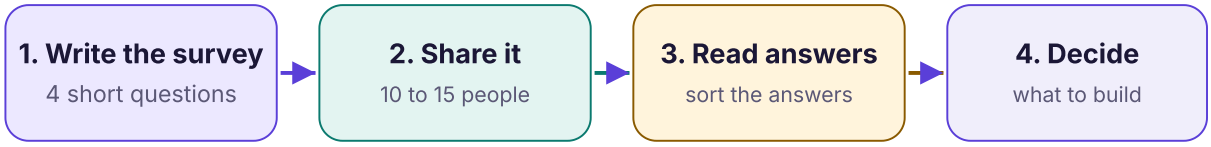
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CHAPTER 2

Market Research

Before you make a course, a website or an ad, find out what people really need and how they talk about it. This chapter shows you how to ask, how to read the answers and how to decide what to build. It costs nothing to start.

Chapter 2 at a glance



Part	What it covers
Core objective	Find problems that are urgent and not yet solved. Collect words your customers use. Build a free waiting list.
Key ideas	Three simple survey questions, a difficulty filter, benefit-led messages, and a 'How-To + Why it matters' table.
Action checklist	Write a survey, share it with 10 to 15 people, read the answers, pick three ideas.
Common mistakes	Building before asking. Spamming contacts. Choosing problems people can already solve easily.

Go back to Chapter 1 any time: Chapter 1, Introduction.

INTERACTIVE WORKSHOP

Practise this chapter in your browser: build a survey, filter sample answers, pick subject lines and write your own ideas: https://claude.ai/artifact/XQhCWixR7eip5riUcSN3nd

CHAPTER 2 · LECTURE 2.1

Why market research works

Most failed ads, blog posts and products skip this step. People did not ask for them.

When you research first, you get three things at once:

1. **A list of problems people want solved.** You learn which problems are urgent and which ones people will pay to fix.
2. **Words for your marketing.** Customers describe their problems in their own words. Those words make the best headlines, emails and ads.
3. **A waiting list.** People who answer your survey and leave an email are warm leads, before you build anything.

As a freelancer, you can offer the same process to clients. You hand them a short list of validated problems and the words to use when they talk about them.

THINK ABOUT IT

Write down one thing you believe your customers want. Ask yourself: have I heard this from a real person?

CHAPTER 2 · LECTURE 2.2

Set up your free Google Forms survey

Google Forms is free. It has no limit on questions or answers, and it gives you simple reports.

Step by step

1. Open Google Forms and sign in with your Google account.
2. Click **Blank** to start an empty form.
3. Give it a clear title, with your topic. Example: *Digital Marketing Survey*.
4. Add the four questions in the table below. Choose the question type shown for each one.
5. Turn on the option to collect email addresses only if you want the waiting list (Question 4).
6. Click **Send** and copy the link. You will share this link in Section 2.3.

The 4 questions

No.	Type	Exact question	Why you ask it
1	Short answer	What is your biggest problem with [your topic]?	Finds the main problem. Short answers keep it focused.
2	Paragraph	Why would it make a difference in your life to get a good answer for this problem or find a solution for your need? Details, please.	Shows what a good result means to them. Their exact words become your sales copy.
3	Multiple choice	How difficult has it been for you to find a good answer for the above to date? Options: Not at all difficult, Somewhat difficult, Very difficult	Shows which problems are still unsolved. This is your filter.
4 (bonus)	Short answer	Add your email below if you would like to be contacted when we have a solution to your problem.	Builds a waiting list of people who asked to hear from you.

YOUR TURN: WRITE YOUR SURVEY

Topic: _____

Q1: _____

Q2: _____

Q3 options: Not at all difficult / Somewhat difficult / Very difficult

Q4: _____

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CHAPTER 2 · LECTURE 2.3

Share your survey, even with no audience

You do not need a big list. Ten to fifteen real people can give you useful answers.

Channel 1: Email people you know

If you already have an email list, send one message through Mailchimp with the survey link.

If you have no list, use your own contacts:

1. Export your contacts from Google Contacts (follow Google's export guide).
2. Download your LinkedIn connections from your LinkedIn data settings (look for *Get a copy of your data*, then *Connections*).
3. Choose 10 to 15 people who would really benefit, or who know someone who would.
4. Write each one a short, personal message. Do not send a group blast.

Pick a subject line that gives a reason to open

Type	Example	Why
Avoid	I have invited you to fill in a form	It gives the reader nothing.
Avoid	Can you spare a few minutes?	It only asks for their time.
Use (warm)	I am creating a new course for you, and I would love your input	It says you are building something for them.
Use (cold)	Hi [Name], could I try to solve your problems as a [their role]?	It names their role and offers help.

Channel 2: Facebook and LinkedIn groups

Search for your topic (for example, *financial independence*). Join active groups and wait for approval. Read the rules first, then post a helpful message:

> *Hi everyone, I am curious what your biggest problems are as [your niche]. Fill out my short survey below. I am happy to share the results and help brainstorm solutions.*

Groups for Facebook: facebook.com/groups. Groups for LinkedIn: linkedin.com/groups.

Channel 3: Forums and Reddit

Search Google for your niche with the word *forum*, or search for relevant communities on Reddit. Join a few threads and share your survey where the community allows it.

BE RESPECTFUL WHEN YOU REACH OUT

- Only contact people who would find your survey useful. Do not send mass messages.
- Read each group's rules before you post. Some groups allow links only on certain days.
- Keep contact details private. Do not share someone's email without their permission.
- Always let people opt out, and remove anyone who asks.

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CHAPTER 2 · LECTURE 2.4

Read the answers in Google Sheets

After 1 to 2 days, most answers have arrived. Now sort them.

Three steps

1. **Open the results.** In Google Forms, open *Responses*, then click *View in Sheets*. Your answers appear in a spreadsheet.
2. **Filter for Very difficult.** Select the top row, create a filter, and filter Question 3 to show only *Very difficult*. In the course example, about 40 percent of answers were this type. That number is an example, not a rule. Your number may be different.
3. **Make a second tab.** Add a tab with two columns: *Problem (as a How-To title)* and *Why it matters (customer benefits)*.

Turn answers into ideas

Read each filtered answer and rewrite it as a How-To title. Keep the customer's reason in the second column. These two columns become your course titles, blog posts, videos and sales copy.

What the person wrote (Q1)	How-To title	Why it matters (Q2 idea)
Can you show me the most direct path to getting a minimal product in the market?	How to get a minimum viable product to market in 1 day	Saves time. Gives a clear step-by-step path.
How do I earn a client's trust when I ask for budget and analytics access?	How to earn a client's trust as a freelance digital marketer	Removes the main reason clients say no.
How does voice search affect SEO?	How to rank for voice search on mobile	Brings free visitors to your website.

YOUR TURN: 3 IDEAS

Idea 1 (How-To): _____ Why it matters: _____

Idea 2 (How-To): _____ Why it matters: _____

Idea 3 (How-To): _____ Why it matters: _____

CHAPTER 2 · LECTURE 2.5

Get feedback without a survey

If you do not want to send a form, or you want more depth, use these three methods.

Method 1: Talk to people

Use the three questions as a short conversation. Let the person talk. Write their words down.

Question	Example: a business owner with 18 staff	Example: a parent of a 5-month-old baby
1. Biggest problem?	Managing 18 people is exhausting.	My baby will not sleep at night.
2. What difference would a solution make?	I could focus on growth, not HR problems.	Less stress, fewer arguments, more energy.
3. How difficult has it been?	Very difficult. Recruits keep being a poor fit.	Very difficult. We tried books and courses.
Possible idea	A hiring checklist and an onboarding plan for small teams.	A sleep-training course for new parents.

Method 2: Search inside Facebook groups

Open a group where your customers talk. Use the group's search bar with these words:

- **complaint:** shows frustration with tools and platforms.
- **hate:** shows tasks people want to remove.
- **bottleneck:** shows what slows them down.
- **stress:** shows where they want relief.

Method 3: Read reviews

Reviews show what is missing. Look for 3-star reviews, because they are often balanced. Very angry or very happy reviews are less useful.

- **Online courses:** look at competing courses on Udemy and note repeated complaints.
- **Products:** look at 3-star product reviews on Amazon for durability or size problems.
- **Local businesses:** sort local results on Google Maps or TripAdvisor by lowest rating to find service gaps.

CHECK FIRST

Review sites change their pages and their rules. Use only public reviews. Do not copy reviews word for word into your marketing. Write your own summary.

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CHAPTER 2 · LECTURE 2.6

Your assignment and checklist

This is what you finish before you move to Chapter 3.

Your assignment

1. Write your 4-question survey in Google Forms.
2. Share it with 10 to 15 people, in 3 groups, and in 2 forums or Reddit communities (where allowed).
3. Read the answers in Google Sheets. Filter for Very difficult. Write at least 3 How-To ideas, each with its reason to buy.

Step-by-step checklist

Done	Step
☐	Survey written and tested (Lecture 2.2)
☐	Contact list made, 10 to 15 names chosen (Lecture 2.3)
☐	Survey shared in groups and forums, following their rules (Lecture 2.3)
☐	Answers read after 1 to 2 days, filtered for Very difficult (Lecture 2.4)
☐	3 How-To ideas written (Lecture 2.4)
☐	Feedback from 1 conversation or 1 group search (Lecture 2.5)

Common mistakes

- Building a blog or running an ad before you know the problem.
- Using the default Google Forms email subject line.
- Sending to your whole contact list at once.
- Choosing problems people can already solve easily.

Next: Chapter 3, Make a website (read now). Practise it here: Make a website workshop.

REFLECTION

Which problem surprised you most? What words did your customers use that you would never have guessed?